

Useful Windows Keyboard Commands

Window & Desktop Management

- **Windows + Left/Right Arrow:** Snap window to the left/right half of screen
- **Windows + Up Arrow:** Maximize window
- **Windows + Down Arrow:** Minimize or restore window
- **Windows + D:** Show/hide desktop
- **Windows + Tab:** Open Task View (virtual desktops and window overview)
- **Windows + Ctrl + D:** Create new virtual desktop
- **Windows + Ctrl + Left/Right:** Switch between virtual desktops
- **Windows + Ctrl + F4:** Close current virtual desktop

Search & Navigation

- **Windows + S / Windows + Q:** Open Windows Search
- **Windows + E:** Open File Explorer
- **Windows + R:** Open Run dialog
- **Windows + X:** Open Power User menu
- **Windows + I:** Open Settings
- **Alt + Tab:** Switch between open apps

System Utilities

- **Windows + Pause/Break:** Open System Properties
- **Windows + L:** Lock your PC
- **Windows + Shift + S:** Open Snipping Tool for screenshots
- **Windows + V:** Open Clipboard history
- **Windows + . / Windows + ;:** Open emoji picker

Power User Tips

- **Ctrl + Shift + Esc:** Open Task Manager
- **Windows + Number (1-9):** Open/switch to the app pinned to that taskbar position

Understanding Virtual Desktops

Virtual Desktops allow you to create multiple desktop environments on a single physical monitor. This is especially helpful for multitasking, organizing workflows, and reducing screen clutter.

Key Features:

- Each virtual desktop can have its own open windows and applications.
- They do not affect each other directly; switching desktops hides the previous one's windows.
- Useful for separating different tasks — for example:
- Desktop 1: Development environment

- Desktop 2: Browsers and research
- Desktop 3: Communication tools (email, chat)

Common Use Cases:

- Keeping work and personal tasks separate
- Running presentations while having notes or tools open on a different desktop
- Organizing projects by role or client

Shortcuts for Virtual Desktops:

- **Windows + Ctrl + D:** Create a new virtual desktop
- **Windows + Ctrl + Left/Right:** Switch between desktops
- **Windows + Ctrl + F4:** Close the current desktop
- **Windows + Tab:** Open Task View to manage desktops visually

Virtual desktops are a built-in productivity tool in Windows 10 and 11, helping users to stay focused and organized by creating mental and visual boundaries between contexts.